Unit 1 - Communication and Employability in IT
Assignment 2

Introduction

I work as a Social Media and communication consultant. I have been asked to test and evaluate a range of communication technologies and techniques to assess their viability for use by employees and professionals in businesses. I will now present my finding on the communication methods I used and then write a report to discuss barriers you encountered and possible solutions to reduce them.

Explain mechanisms that can reduce the impact of communication barriers

Twitter

The biggest communication barrier for twitter is the limit of 140 characters. Most people's solution to this barrier is to write shorter sentences, but there are other ways of overcoming this barrier. For example, only posting links, some companies do this on their twitter account. The reason this is done is so that the customers can click on the link, which would take them to a page which would contain a lot more detailed information than a tweet would.

This could be done by the company's IT or communication specialist which could be proofread by a manager or someone with a similar role. This can consume time because of checking for spelling or grammatical mistakes which can require the comms specialist to write the words correctly and the manager to read over the text cautiously. Some URL links can exceed the 140 character limit, so getting a shorter URL can consume extra time.

Slack Web Messenger

Slack may have instant messaging, which is great, but it does have its barriers. For example, IMs can be dangerous because viruses are easily transferred via disguised URL, the messages can be intercepted or people can get carried away with the IMs and chat to friends and waste time. These barriers can be solved by not pressing unknown URLs, not to share sensitive info over slack and not to get carried away by friends during work.

By doing all this you reduce the chance you can use the slack web messenger safely and use it for its intended purpose for the business. This barrier can be overcome by anyone who is using the slack web messenger if they are responsible enough. This isn't very time consuming because to overcome these barriers you have to prevent doing actions which require time to do.

Forum

There are many communication barriers on forums. For example, they may be sloppy or messy and off topic, a random person can join the forum and spam the threads making the forum less attractive and losing visitors. To overcome these barriers you can have admins or moderators to edit or delete posts made by trolls or spam. Admins and moderators can also control the forum to become a successful and neat form instead of a sloppy, messy, off topic forum.

The reason of doing this you can make the threads on the forum look more professional and attractive to customers looking for questions and answers. The communication specialist or other IT worker can do the job of an admin or moderator of a forum. This can be time consuming because of the time needed to read through the threads to check for bad content in the threads.

Email

One of the vital communication barriers with email is information overload which can lead to misunderstandings of the message. The solution to this barrier is to reduce the amount of information sent via email. The reason for this is to reduce misunderstanding when the receiver is reading the email. This can reduce time wasting, clarifies and, which would be the worst case scenario if this happened, reducing the misinterpretation of the message.

Anyone who is writing an email can have this responsibility, but it's an important responsibility to have, especially when writing to a member of staff higher in the hierarchy, like a manager. This can be time consuming because of the reading over the email to see if information flows correctly and checking if there is too much information, but it would be more time consuming cramming a lot of information into one email and then it being misunderstood by the reader.

Group discussion

Confidence is a big barrier when speaking to groups of individuals. The solution to this barrier is to overcome the lack of confidence and feel more confident around groups of people. Doing this would get you to contribute to the group discussion, which could bring questions or answers that others wouldn't. If a person with lack of confidence speaks, his voice might not be loud enough for other individuals to hear, including the minute taker.

Anyone who is an introvert and is part of a group discussion can have this issue and can be able to overcome the issue. How long it would take to overcome the issue depends how shy a person really is, even though it is possible to overcome the shyness, some people do take a long time to overcome it. However, if the shyness is overcome, he may have the confidence for a long time and would be hard to lose it, especially if the group discussions are with the same people.

Evaluate interpersonal and written communications techniques

In this part of the report, I will be writing an evaluative report that assesses my own interpersonal and written communication skills I have used so far in this unit.

Twitter

When I was using twitter I made sure that my words were spelt correctly, this reason for this is because the discussion was about a serious topic and that the spelling had to be serious enough to be respected, this can also be applied to when I am representing a business in the future. Showing positivity is important in twitter is important so that my language and responses doesn't offend other users or to seem disinterested in the topic.

The area I feel that I need to improve in is to have the confidence to speak to more people, I feel that this is a problem because I sometimes have an answer to a question or I have a question myself but I don't reply or ask the question because of my lack of confidence. This can be a problem in the future because I have to overcome this issue because I would need to answer questions asked towards the business over twitter.

In conclusion for my communication over twitter, I need to improve on the social barrier skills because of my confidence, If that is overcome it would benefit me a lot in the future.

Slack Web Messenger

When I used slack I made sure that the sentences I wrote had proper spelling and grammar, this is so my statements are understood by others and that the information I have written can be read with ease and wouldn't cause misunderstandings. This skill will be useful for future employment because you need people to know what you are saying and what information you are putting across.

The area I feel that needs to improve is to not get carried away from the laid back software like slack. What I mean by this is that instant messaging is mostly used when talking to friends, and getting into the mindset to speak to friends is easily attained by slack. I feel that this is a problem because this can be very distracting in a working environment, which can reduce the amount of required work to do. I have to overcome this issue by getting work motivation and to not get distracted by other colleagues.

In conclusion for Slack, I need to improve on my relevance to contributions because I can get easily distracted by the laid back layout of slack and the use of direct messages to colleagues.

Forum

When I used the forum, I made sure that the information included in my posts were accurate, this is very important due to the fact that, in a discussion, false information is worse than no information. It may lead to corrections by other people, or worse, people believing the false statement. Having importance of accuracy is very important for future employment because false information can be very embarrassing and unprofessional to the company.

The area I feel I need to improve is to look at information much more closely. I feel that this is a problem because some sources of information is false and isn't very accurate. Some sources can be correct, but to know that I would have to research through different types of websites and articles to reinforce that they are true. Having the skill of importance of accuracy is important in a business because it makes it look professional and a good source for information, which is important in a forum.

In conclusion for forums, I would need to improve on importance of accuracy due to the importance of accurate information on a forum which is where people look for questions and answers, especially for a business.

Email

When I used the email, I made sure the formality was one of my priorities. The reason being is because emails are mostly used for important purposes and should always be a formal way to communicate. Having an informal email looks very unprofessional, especially if you are writing to someone important like a manager or the boss. The structure of the email also makes the email look well presented, which would be a bonus because it makes it look very professional when mixed with formal writing.

The area I feel I need to improve is the structure of an email. I feel that I need to improve this because I very rarely use emails, this means that I don’t how how to structure one properly. This skill is very important to have once I move into a employment in the future, because if I have to communicate with a boss or manager I would have to use the email because it's a formal and professional way to communicate.

In conclusion for email, I would need to improve the specific format of the email to make it look more professional and formal, a skill which is important due to the fact emails are used for formal communication.

Group discussion

When I did the group discussion I made sure that my tone of voice was loud enough for the individuals in the group could hear what I was saying. The reason for this is so that they would not misunderstand me or not to tell me to repeat myself, which would waste time in the

discussion. Having a good tone of voice can also make it seem I am confident in what I am saying.

The area I feel i need to improve on is asking more questions, open and closed. I feel this way because I answer questions but I don't ask them, this skill might be important because I might bring up something that no one else would. This can important for future employment because I could bring up good questions in a group discussion which could benefit a business, it may seem unlikely, but it is very possible.

In conclusion to the group discussion, I need to improve on the questioning, due to the fact that questions are very important in a discussion and it could help me in a future meeting with colleagues on a future employment.